

Craig Simpson

Lead Cloud Architect / Engineer

Cardiff, UK | Open to Remote & Relocation

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Professional Summary

Lead Cloud Architect and DevOps specialist with 10+ years of experience designing, scaling, and automating high-availability multi-cloud environments across AWS, Azure, and OpenStack.

Hands-on expertise with Red Hat OpenShift, Kubernetes, and Terraform, combined with a track record of guiding teams through complex cloud transformations.

Trusted by startups and enterprises alike to drive modernization and DevSecOps adoption — blending strategy, automation, and technical excellence.

Consulting Highlights

- Architected OpenStack and OpenShift platforms for telecom, finance, and media clients across EMEA.
 - Lead Architect on a OpenStack Private GPU Cloud, took the design from concept to a resilient pair of geographically separate data centers.
 - Advised CTOs and engineering leads on multi-cloud strategy, CI/CD automation, and infrastructure modernization.
 - Led transformation workshops to drive DevOps culture and operational maturity.
 - Designed the deployment strategy for major media companies workloads, dictating when to use Containers, Serverless or Bare Metal.
 - Acted as SME for two distinct Critical National Infrastructure OpenShift deployments.
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Core Skills

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, Oracle, DigitalOcean, Cloudflare

Private Cloud & OpenStack: Red Hat OpenStack, Canonical OpenStack, CEPH, Keystone

Private Cloud & OpenStack: Red Hat OpenStack, Canonical OpenStack, CentOS, Rocky Linux, Neutron, Nova, Heat.

Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes, Red Hat OpenShift, Docker, Rancher.

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible, Helm, SaltStack. **DevOps & CI/CD:** GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, ArgoCD. Concourse, Drone.io

Monitoring & Observability: Elastic, DataDog, Splunk, Grafana, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, RedHat Telemetry Framework. **Networking & Security:** OpenContrail, OpenVSwitch, Contrail, Cisco Nexus Stack.

Languages: Python, Bash, Perl. **Methodologies:** DevSecOps, Agile, Site Reliability Engineering, Defense in Depth.

Professional Experience

Lead OpenShift Architect | National Grid — Remote

Dec 2025 – Apr 2026

- Designed CNI secure system architecture for OpenShift platforms supporting critical national infrastructure.
- Delivered High-Level Design (HLD) and Low-Level Design (LLD) documentation for platform teams.
- Led stakeholder engagement sessions on security frameworks, aligning platform architecture with regulatory requirements.
- Produced architecture decision records and governance artefacts for multi-team consumption.

Principal Cloud Architect | Bauer Media — Remote

Feb 2025 – Oct 2025

- Lead architect for multi-region scaling of the Rayo audio app backend across AWS and Azure.
- Designed GDPR-compliant right-shoring for databases, ensuring full EU data sovereignty.
- Member of Bauer Digital Audio's Technology Steering Board.
- Authored integration patterns, Terraform modules, and DevSecOps guardrails adopted globally.

OpenShift Virtualization Architect | Motorola — Remote

Nov 2024 – Jan 2025

- Architected OpenShift Virtualization deployment within a fully airgapped CNI environment with restricted network egress.
- Defined disconnected deployment strategy, including mirror registry setup and operator lifecycle management without internet access.
- Performed platform hardening in line with CIS benchmarks and government security standards.
- Authored operational runbooks covering day-2 operations, upgrade procedures, and incident response for platform teams.

Cloud Architect | KX — Remote

Jul 2023 – Dec 2024

- Delivered OpenShift and Kubernetes-based analytics platforms for global enterprise clients.
- Designed cloud-native architecture supporting multi-tenant, high-performance workloads.
- Developed Terraform/Helm frameworks, standardizing hybrid-cloud deployments.
- Implemented GitOps via ArgoCD and GitLab CI/CD — boosted release velocity by 50%.

Lead Cloud Architect (OpenStack / OpenShift / DevOps) | Rackspace Technology — Remote

Apr 2021 – Feb 2023

- EMEA SME for OpenStack/OpenShift for government and finance sectors.
- Built OpenShift clusters integrated with OpenStack and CEPH for secure workloads.
- Designed hybrid-cloud CI/CD automation pipelines.
- Authored reference architectures and reusable IaC templates.
- Mentored teams on DevOps transformation.
- Designed a Government clients OpenStack goal which was to reach six datacenters in size by 2030.

Senior DevOps Engineer | SECCL — Bath

Jan 2020 – Apr 2020

- Migrated monolith to serverless microservices using AWS Lambda.
- Introduced observability with Grafana and CloudWatch.
- Reduced manual ops by 70% via CI/CD + IaC.
- Built an on-demand Kubernetes development system which cut the cloud bill by 15-20%.

Cloud Architect | O2 (Telefonica UK) — Slough / Remote

Nov 2019 – Dec 2020

- Designed and deployed OpenStack-based private cloud supporting O2's 5G packet-core infrastructure.
- Automated deployments with Ansible and Heat templates, cutting provisioning time by 40%.
- Authored operations documentation and continuity playbooks for ongoing support.

Senior Red Hat Infrastructure Engineer | Crossvale — Remote / On-Site

Mar 2019 – Nov 2019

- Delivered OpenShift, OpenStack, and CEPH infrastructure deployments for enterprise clients.
- Automated provisioning with Ansible and developed Kubernetes deployment frameworks.
- Provided Red Hat engineering support and training during on-site engagements.

Senior Systems Engineer → Platform Engineer (DevOps) | thevoicefactory / Capgemini / Backbase

2015 – 2019

- Designed and deployed OpenStack clusters and CI/CD systems across enterprise workloads.
- Automated infrastructure builds with Terraform and SaltStack.